

23TRCV03521 23TRCV03521

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: 5

Hearing date: 2026-07-09

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Case Number: 23TRCV03521 Hearing Date: July 9, 2026 Dept: 5

Superior Court of California

County of Los Angeles – SOUTHWEST District

Department

5

IMARA JONES

;

Plaintiff,

vs.

NISSAN NORTH AMERICA, INC.

;

Defendant.

Case

No.:

23TRCV03521

Hearing

Date:

July
9, 2026

Time:

8:30 a.m.

[tentative]

Order RE:

(1)

Plaintiff

IMARA JONES' MOTION FOR ATTORNEYS' FEES, COSTS, AND EXPENSES

MOVING PARTY: Plaintiff, Imara Jones

RESPONDING

PARTY: Defendant, Nissan North

America, Inc.

(1)

Plaintiff

Imara Jones's Motion for Attorneys' Fees, Costs, and Expenses is GRANTED in the reduced amount of \$53,325.35 pursuant to Civil Code section 1794, subdivision (d).

The Court considers the moving papers filed on May 6, 2026, the opposition brief filed on June 12 and 15, 2026, and the reply brief filed on June 23, 2026.

Factual Background

On October 23, 2023, plaintiff Imara Jones ("Plaintiff") filed the Complaint against defendants Nissan North America, Inc. ("Defendant") and DOES 1 through 10. The Complaint includes the following causes of action: (1) Statutory Violation of California Civil Code section 1793.2(d) – Failure to Repurchase/Replace; (2) Statutory Violation of California Civil Code section 1793.2(b) – Failure to Complete Repairs within 30 Days; (3) Statutory Violation of California Civil Code section 1794 – Breach of

Express Warranty; (4) Statutory Violation of California Civil Code section 1791.1, 1794 – Breach of Implied Warranty of Merchantability; and (5) Violation of the Business and Professions Code section 17200.

On June 26, 2025, Plaintiff filed a Notice of Settlement of Entire Case.

On August 4, 2025, Plaintiff filed an executed Code of Civil Procedure section 998 Offer of Compromise to Defendant.

Defendant accepted Plaintiff's offer on June 23, 2025, agreeing to pay the sum of \$51,000.00, in addition to Plaintiff's "attorney's fees, expenses, and costs that have been reasonably incurred pursuant to California Civil code § 1794(d)[.]" (Declaration of Eric K.

Natenstedt ("Natenstedt Decl."), ¶¶ 4-5, Exh. 19.) Furthermore, Defendant acknowledged Plaintiff as the prevailing party for the purposes of this motion. (Natenstedt Decl., ¶¶ 4-5, Exh. 19.)

On October 7, 2025, Plaintiff filed a memorandum of costs, stating that they incurred \$1,831.10 in costs and expenses. (Natenstedt Decl., ¶ 8; Declaration of Brian K. Cline ("Cline Decl."), ¶ 6, Exh. 1.) Defendant did not file a motion to strike or tax costs. (Natenstedt Decl., ¶ 8.)

Procedural Background

On May 6, 2026, Plaintiff filed this Motion for Attorneys' Fees, Costs, and Expenses. On June 11, 2026, Plaintiff filed a notice of non-opposition.

On June 12, 2026, Defendant filed a solitary declaration without an opposition brief.

On June 15, 2026, Defendant filed an opposition brief along with an Ex Parte Application to Continue Hearing of Plaintiff's Motion for Attorneys' Fees, to ensure that the Court would consider the late opposition brief. On June 16, 2026, the Court granted the ex parte and directed Plaintiff to file a reply brief by June 24, 2026. (June 16, 2026 Minute Order, p. 1.) On June 22, 2026, Plaintiff filed a reply brief.

LEGAL

STANDARD

Attorneys'

fees are allowed as costs when authorized by contract, statute, or law. (Code Civ. Proc, § 1033.5, subd. (a)(10)(B).) In a lemon law action, costs and expenses, including attorney's fees, may be recovered by a prevailing buyer under the Song-Beverly Act. (See Civ. Code, § 1794, subd. (d).)

Section

1794 provides: "If the buyer prevails in an action under this section, the buyer shall be allowed by the court to recover as part of the judgment a sum equal to the aggregate amount of costs and expenses, including attorney's fees based on actual time expended, determined by the court to have been reasonably incurred by the buyer in connection with the commencement and prosecution of such action." (Civ. Code, § 1794, subd. (d).)

Thus, the

statute includes a "reasonable attorney's fees" standard. The attorney bears the burden of proof as to the "reasonableness" of any fee claim. (Code Civ. Proc., § 1033.5, subd. (c)(5).) This burden requires competent evidence as to the nature and value of the services rendered. (Martino v. Denevi (1986) 182 Cal.App.3d 553, 559.) "Testimony of an attorney as to the number of hours worked on a particular case is sufficient evidence to support an award of attorney fees, even in the absence of detailed time records." (Ibid.)

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plaintiff's verified billing invoices are prima facie evidence that the costs, expenses, and services listed were necessarily incurred. (See Hadley v. Krepel (1985) 167 Cal.App.3d 677, 682.) "In challenging attorney fees as excessive because too many hours of work are claimed, it is the burden of the challenging party to point to the specific items challenged, with a sufficient argument and citations to the evidence. General arguments that fees claimed are excessive, duplicative, or unrelated do not suffice." (Lunada Biomedical v. Nunez (2014) 230 Cal.App.4th 459, 488, quoting Premier Med. Mgmt. Sys., Inc. v. California Ins. Guarantee Ass'n (2008) 163 Cal.App.4th 550, 564.) The Court has discretion to reduce fees that result from inefficient or duplicative use of time. (Horsford v. Bd. of Trustees of California State Univ. (2005) 132 Cal. App. 4th 359, 395.)

In

determining a reasonable attorney fee, the trial court begins with the lodestar, i.e., the number of hours reasonably expended multiplied by the reasonable hourly rate. (Warren v.

Kia Motors America, Inc. (2018) 30 Cal.App.5th 24, 36.) The lodestar may then be adjusted based on factors specific to the case in order to fix the fee at the fair market value of the legal services provided. (Ibid.)

The factors that courts look at to

determine if a multiplier is reasonable are: "(1) the novelty and difficulty of the questions involved, and the skill displayed in presenting them; (2) the extent to which the nature of the litigation precluded other employment by the attorneys; (3) the contingent nature of the fee award" and (4) the success achieved. (Serrano v. Priest (1977) 20 Cal.3d 25, 49 (Serrano).)

No specific findings

reflecting the court's calculations are required. The record only needs to show that the attorney's fees were awarded according to the "lodestar" or "touchstone" approach. The court's focus in

evaluating the facts should be to provide a fee award reasonably designed to completely compensate attorneys for the services provided. The starting point for this determination is the attorney's time records. (Horsford v. Board of Trustees of Calif.

State Univ. (2005) 132 Cal.App.4th 359, 395-397 [verified time records entitled to credence absent clear indication they are erroneous].) However, California case law permits fee awards in the absence of detailed time sheets. (Sommers v. Erb (1992) 2

Cal.App.4th 1644, 1651; Dunk v. Ford Motor Co. (1996) 48 Cal.App.4th 1794, 1810; Nightingale v. Hyundai Motor America (1994) 31 Cal.App.4th 99, 103.) An experienced trial judge is

in a position to assess the value of the professional services rendered in his or her court. (Serrano, supra, 20 Cal.3d 25 at p. 49.)

DISCUSSION

It is undisputed that

Plaintiff is the prevailing party for the purpose of this motion and is therefore entitled to attorneys' fees, costs, and expenses pursuant to Civil Code section 1794, subdivision (d). (Motion, pp. 8:8-9:6.) Plaintiff is requesting a

total award of \$58,392.78, which includes: (1) \$46,874.25 in attorneys' fees; (2) a 10% multiplier amounting to \$4,687.43; (3) \$5,000.00 in anticipated attorneys' fees for the preparation of the reply brief and oral argument at the hearing; and (4) \$1,831.10 in costs and expenses. (Notice of Motion, p. 1:17-23; Motion, p. 1:11-15.)

In response, Defendant asserts that the Court should reduce the requested amount by no less than 20%, limit the hourly rates to a maximum of \$400 per hour, and deny the multiplier. (Opp., p. 1:3-18.) However, upon reviewing the reasonableness of the requested fees, the Court has determined that a more appropriate award is \$53,325.35.

Reasonableness of the Hourly Rates

Plaintiff requests the hourly rates detailed in the following table. (Cline Decl., ¶¶ 7-9, 12-13, 34-43, Exh. 2.)

Name

Position

Years of Experience

2023 Hourly Rate

2024 Hourly Rate

2025 Hourly Rate

2026 Hourly Rate

Brian K. Cline
(BKC)

Founding Attorney

20

N/A

\$650.00

N/A

N/A

Mark Johnson (MJ)

Managing Litigation Counsel

15

\$510.00

\$600.00

\$625.00

N/A

Eric Natenstedt
(EN)

Senior

Associate

12

N/A

\$600.00

\$625.00

\$687.50

Jeffrey Moses (JM)

Associate Attorney

11

N/A

N/A

\$550.00

N/A

John Coffey (JC)

Associate Attorney

> 3

N/A

\$400.00

N/A

N/A

Ashley J. Yaddgo
(AY)

Associate Attorney

< 2

\$325.00

\$350.00

N/A

N/A

Antonio Ibarra

Law Clerk

> 3

\$325.00

N/A

N/A

N/A

Mercedes Dobbertin
(MD)

Paralegal

> 3

\$225.00

N/A

N/A

N/A

Lisa Sassa (LS)

Paralegal

5

\$225.00

\$250.00

\$275.00

N/A

Stephanie Murrieta
(SM)

Paralegal

Unknown

\$225.00

N/A

N/A

N/A

To determine if an hourly rate is reasonable, courts consider the rates of similar attorneys in the community, as well as “the experience, skill, and reputation of the attorney requesting fees.” (Heritage Pacific Financial, LLC v. Monroy (2013) 215 Cal.App.4th 972, 1009.) In the present case, Brian K. Cline’s declaration presents a detailed account of the qualifications and experience of six attorneys, one law clerk, and two paralegals. (Cline Decl., ¶¶ 9, 34-42.) With reference to this declaration and the Court’s own familiarity with the billing rates of Los Angeles-area counsel in similar lemon law cases, the Court finds that the rates are reasonable due to their experience and qualifications.

However, Cline does not provide information on how long Stephanie Murrieta has been working in the legal field or when they obtained their paralegal degree. For this reason, the Court reduces Murrieta’s hourly rate to \$150.00 to better reflect minimal experience. This adjustment results in a reduction of \$135.00.

Reasonableness of the Hours Incurred

Block Billing

Defendant informs the Court that "Plaintiff's proposed invoice is replete with proposed block billed entries." (Opp., p. 3:5.) However, Defendant refrains from listing all block billed entries, asserting that "[t]o list them all would be to simply copy the entire invoice." (Opp., p. 3:6.)

Instead, Defendant presents several particularly "egregious" examples, which include: (1) "1.3 hours to review upcoming dates, draft case management statement, draft notice of jury fee deposit, file documents, update filing expenses, and more (4/24/24)[;]" (2) "1.1 hours to review repair history, appear for CMC, draft CMC outcome, update dates, and more (5/15/24)[;]" (3) "1.3 hours to review CMC outcome summary, meet with client, leave voicemail for defendant, meet with counsel for defendant, and more (5/15/24)[;]" (4) "1.7 hours to leave voicemail, draft CMC summary sheet, leave another voicemail, meet with client, meet with mediator, and file notes (6/25/24)[;]" (5) "1.6 hours to review instructions for another attorney, review repair history, draft case progress summary, prepare for mediation, meet with client, draft and send client instructions, email client confirmation of settlement authority (8/5/24)[;]" (6) "1.8 hours to review document production files, create warranty claim history chart, research TSBs, draft document production summary, conduct legal research re MTC, meet with client, draft client instructions re updated financials (8/7/24)[;]" (7) "3.8 hours to review all client documents, meet with client, conduct mediation, draft mediation outcome summary, and more (8/13/24)[;]" and (8) "1.4 hours and then 1.8 hours to conduct numerous tasks such as reviewing prior settlement offers, meeting with counsel, meeting with client, drafting 998, and more (5/28/25, 6/5/25)[;]" (Opp., p. 3:7-24.)

The use of block billing is not per se objectionable. Block billing is only problematic "when the practice prevents them from discerning which tasks are compensable and which are not." (Heritage Pac. Fin. LLC v. Monroy (2013) 215 Cal.App.4th 972, 1010.) Because of block billing, courts find it difficult to assess the reasonableness of the time spent on individual tasks, such that courts must make a determination without the information that would result from non-block billed entries.

The Court recognizes that all the cited time entries are combined or "block billed." Nevertheless, it observes that none of the

listed tasks appear to be non-compensable. Although Defendant contends that these entries are “vague or serve no apparent purpose[.]” the Court disagrees. (Opp., p. 3:26.) For example, Defendant references the entry

dated August 5, 2024, which includes billing for “Draft case progress to date summary.” (Opp., p. 3:26-28.) Upon review, it is evident that Plaintiff’s counsel prepared a summary of the case for the purpose of an upcoming mediation. The Court deems this entry necessary for effective litigation.

Regarding Defendant’s argument

that even if the Court finds all the tasks compensable, “the Court cannot tell if time spent on each individual task was reasonable[.]” the Court partially concurs. While the Court cannot ascertain the exact time allocated to each task, upon reviewing each identified entry, it concludes that the requested hours are reasonable, as all combined tasks were completed within a reasonable amount of time.

Consequently, the Court declines to reduce the requested attorneys’ fees on the basis of block billing.

Clerical Tasks

Defendant contends that

numerous “clerical entries are intertwined within many of the block billed entries.” (Opp., p. 4:4.) To support this assertion, Defendant cites several “representative examples[.]” including: (1) “ ‘Update firm total cases spreadsheet re: present case’ - 11/02/23[.]” (2) “ ‘Calendaring dates, updating calendar, reviewing calendar and the like – 12/26/23, 2/8/24, 4/24/24, 5/15/24, 5/29/24, 6/6/24, 6/20/24, 6/25/24, 8/16/24, 8/20/24, 10/7/24, 10/8/24, 1/28/25, 3/7/25, 8/8/25, 12/8/25, 4/27/26[.]” (3) “ ‘Saved OL credit card receipt to file’ - 4/25/24[.]” (4) “ ‘Reviewed LA Court connect instructions’ – 5/13/24[.]” (5) “ ‘Reserve remote appearance for upcoming hearings’ – 9/27/24[.]” and (6) “ ‘Research motion reservation process on Court’s website’ – 4/25/25[.]” (Opp., p. 4:7-14.)

“[F]or tasks that are purely

clerical, ‘[i]t simply is not reasonable for a lawyer to bill, at her regular hourly rate, for tasks that a non-attorney employed by her could perform at a much lower cost.’ Davis v. City &

Cty. of San Francisco, 976 F.2d 1536, 1543 (9th Cir. 1992), vacated on other grounds, 984 F.2d 345 (9th Cir. 1993); see also Zargarian v. BMW

of N. Am., LLC, No. CV 18-4857-RSWL-PLA, 2020 WL 1129864, at *8 (C.D. Cal. Mar. 3, 2020) (“It is well established that a plaintiff may not recover fees for time spent on purely clerical work.”) (citing Davis, 976 F.2d at 1543).” (Whitaker v. Beverly Falafel, Inc. (C.D. Cal. Sept. 15, 2020, Case No. 2:19-cv-10127-SVW-GJS) 2020 WL 6494193, * 3.)

While some of these tasks may appear clerical at first glance, the Court emphasizes that a plaintiff is not permitted to recover for “purely clerical tasks.” Defendant does not demonstrate that these particular tasks are purely clerical. The Court will not make this argument on their behalf.

Internal Communications and Duplicative Billing

Defendant asserts that the invoice in question includes charges for internal communications and instances of duplicative work. (Opp., p. 5:3-11.) Defendant provides several specific examples, including: (1) “SM, MJ, and Antonio Ibarra each reviewed repair documents (see entries on 10/18/23 through 10/20/23), and then EN reviewed repair documents as well on multiple occasions (8/5/24, 10/7/24, 12/2/24);” (2) “Three different attorneys billed duplicative hours to draft discovery. Ibarra billed 1.1 hours on 10/20/23 to draft specific interrogatories, requests for admissions, and requests for production. AY then billed a duplicative 0.7 hours to review those documents on 12/8/23, and MJ billed 0.3 hours to again review the documents on 12/10/23;” (3) “1.3 hours for attorney AY to review a CMC summary which had been attended and billed at 1.1 hours by a different attorney, JC – see entries on 5/15/24;” (4) “0.3 hours to meet with another attorney, billed on 5/21/24;” (5) “Double billing for attorney meetings on 8/5/24;” (6) “3.7 hours by AY and then 1.3 hours by EN to each review Defendant’s Special Interrogatories – 9/17/24;” (7) “Multiple entries by AY to ‘receive and review documents related to the matter,’ ‘send same to supervising attorneys,’ and the like – 8/29/24, 10/3/24, 11/15/24;” (8) “Drafting summary of meeting to send to another attorney – 10/31/24;” (9) “Meeting with another attorney – 12/13/24;” (10) “Work to catch up following departure of attorney Jeff Moses – 4/23/25;” (11) “Duplicative billing to conduct research re motion to compel – see 4/23/25 and 5/12/25;” (12) “Double billing for an internal conference and preparation for same – 4/29/25 and 4/30/25;” (13) “Correspondence with other attorneys re meet and confer and discovery – 5/27/25;” (14) “1.4 hours to review prior settlement offers history – 5/28/25;” and (15) “0.2 hours to correspond with other attorney, no further explanation – 10/3/25;” (Opp., pp. 5:12-6:7.)

“As noted above, a fee applicant ‘should make a good-faith effort to exclude from a fee request hours that are ... redundant, or otherwise unnecessary.’ [Citation.]

. The Ninth Circuit has ‘recognized that “the participation of more than one attorney does not necessarily constitute an unnecessary duplication of effort.” ’ [Citation.] However, in general, counsel should not bill for internal communications and communicating with each other, as such time is unnecessary. [Citation.]” (Durham v. FCA US LLC (E.D.Cal. Jan. 16, 2020, No. 2:17-cv-00596-JLT) 2020 WL 243115, at *5.)

Plaintiff contends that the Court must deny this reduction on the grounds that Defendant has not met its burden in presenting “specific, evidence-based objections to specific entries.” (Reply, p. 8:5.) The Court disagrees with this assertion. As outlined, Defendant references specific entries and raises objections based on internal communications and duplication. While Defendant does not provide contradictory evidence, it relies on Plaintiff’s own documentation, specifically the invoice, to illustrate that certain entries pertain to internal communications or duplicative efforts.

Upon thorough review, the Court finds that entries 4, 5, 9, and 11 to 13 involve either internal communications or duplicative work. However, entries 5, 9, and 11 to 13 include blocked billing, creating ambiguity regarding the precise amount of time spent on internal communications and duplicative activities. Defendant proposes an unsupported 20% reduction; however, without a comprehensive rationale for the appropriateness of this percentage, the Court declines to impose such a reduction. (Opp., p. 6:8-9.) Consequently, the Court denies the award of attorneys’ fees for entries 4 and 16, both of which involve internal communications. This leads to reductions of \$105.00 and \$140.00, culminating in a total reduction of \$245.00.

Templates

Defendant argues that the Court should reduce the hours requested by Plaintiff due to their counsel’s use of templates. (Opp., pp. 6:13-7:1.) Specifically, Defendant references the following entries: (1) “1.1 hours on 10/20/23 to draft specifical

interrogatories, requests for admissions, and requests for production[;]" (2) "0.7 hours to review those documents on 12/8/23[;]" and (3) "0.3 hours to again review the documents on 12/10/23."

(Opp., p. 6:15-17.) Defendant

submits evidence indicating the use of templates and asserts that these documents required minimal effort, suggesting they could have been completed by a paralegal under minimal supervision by an associate in approximately 0.5 hours. (Opp., pp. 6:24-7:1; Declaration of Jason Richardson ("Richardson Decl."), ¶ 2, Exh. A.) Nevertheless, the Court finds this argument unconvincing.

After reviewing Exhibit A of

Jason Richardson's declaration, the Court acknowledges that Plaintiff indeed utilized templates in preparing the discovery documents. However, the Court disagrees with the assertion that the hours claimed are unreasonable. The expenditure of 2.1 hours to make modifications and review three sets of discovery requests is deemed reasonable.

As articulated by Plaintiff, "Each task requires reviewing case-specific facts, conducting legal research, and conferring with the client to ensure accuracy and completeness." (Reply, p. 6:10-11.)

Consequently, the Court declines to reduce the requested attorneys' fees incurred in connection with the use of templates.

Attorneys' Fees Motion

Defendant requests that the

Court deny any fees incurred in the filing of this motion, contending that (1) "Plaintiff's counsel failed to meaningfully confer with [Defendant] and attempt to resolve fees informally[;]" and (2) the amount requested is excessive, as the motion is "routine," employs "boilerplate templates," and necessitates "relatively little customization or effort." (Opp., pp. 10:7-11:27.) The Court disagrees.

Defendant references three

federal cases: *Hadian v. Toyota Motor Sales, USA, Inc. et al.* (C.D.Cal.

Mar. 12, 2026, No. 8:25-cv-01223-ADS), *Gomez v. Ford Motor Company* (C.D.Cal. Feb. 15, 2024, No. 2:23-cv-03454-SVW-JC) 2024 WL 724730, and *Peraza*

v. Ford Motor Company (C.D.Cal. May 27, 2022, No. 2:20-cv-08898-AB-AGR)

2022 WL 3098062, along with a trial court order from *Rodriguez v. Ford Motor Co.* (Cal. Super. Dec. 16,

2021, No. CIVDS1817924) 2021 WL 6276308, to assert that Plaintiff should have met and conferred with Defendant and provided their attorneys' fees invoice prior to filing this motion. (Opp., pp. 10:20-11:18.) However, none of these cases substantiate Defendant's argument. The federal cases denied Plaintiff's requested attorney fees on the basis of noncompliance with Central District of California Local Rule 7-3. Furthermore, Defendant fails to cite any state statute or local regulation that mandates parties to meet and confer before filing a motion for attorneys' fees.

While a state trial court previously denied a plaintiff's request for fees associated with a motion for attorneys' fees for not providing "a sneak peek to Defense Counsel to avoid the motion altogether and importantly save scarce judicial resources[.]" this Court opts not to adopt such reasoning. (Rodriguez v. Ford Motor Co. (Cal. Super. Dec. 16, 2021, No. CIVDS1817924) 2021 WL 6276308, at *1.) Plaintiff was not required to confer under state law or binding case law, and this Court will not impose such a requirement.

With respect to Defendant's claim that the Court should reject the requested fees on the grounds that the motion is a template, the Court finds this argument equally unpersuasive. (Opp., p. 11:19-27.) Defendant does not present any alternative motions to demonstrate that this motion is indeed boilerplate or that Plaintiff's counsel exerted minimal effort to customize it.

Consequently, the Court declines to reduce the requested amount of attorneys' fees incurred in relation to the filing of this motion.

Loadstar Multiplier

Plaintiff contends that their legal counsel should be granted a lodestar multiplier of 0.1 or 10%. (Motion, pp. 13:3-14:7.) They assert that such a multiplier is warranted due to the contingent risks associated with pursuing this case and the delays in payment. (Motion, pp. 13:11-14:7.) The Court disagrees.

The factors that courts look at to determine if a multiplier is reasonable are: "(1) the novelty and

difficulty of the questions involved, and the skill displayed in presenting them; (2) the extent to which the nature of the litigation precluded other employment by the attorneys; (3) the contingent nature of the fee award[;]" and (4) the success achieved. (Serrano, supra, 20 Cal.3d at p. 49.) Nonetheless, courts must not consider extraordinary skill and the other Serrano factors to the extent these are already included in the lodestar. (Ketchum v. Moses (2001) 24 Cal.4th 1122, 1138-1139.) "[A] trial court should award a multiplier for exceptional representation only when the quality of representation far exceeds the quality of representation that would have been provided by an attorney of comparable skill and experience billing at the hourly rate used in the lodestar calculation. Otherwise, the fee award will result in unfair double counting and be unreasonable." (Id. at p. 1139.)

The Court finds that a lodestar multiplier is not appropriate for this case, given the circumstances. This is a straightforward lemon law case, and there is nothing to suggest that it involves novel issues or that the quality of representation exceeded what would typically be provided by attorneys of comparable skill and experience billing at similar rates. Additionally, Plaintiff has not argued that their counsel was unable to take on more cases. While Plaintiff asserts that their counsel accepted the case solely on a contingency basis and experienced delayed payment, the Court believes that these considerations and the associated risks are already accounted for in the lodestar amount. This is because the substantial hourly rates approved by the Court reflect those typically charged for lemon law cases pursued on a contingency basis.

Based on the foregoing, the Court declines to grant a lodestar multiplier.

Costs and Expenses

Plaintiff seeks reimbursement in the amount of \$ 1,831.10 for incurred costs and expenses. (Motion, p. 1:13-14, fn. 1.) In support of this request, Plaintiff has filed a memorandum of costs. (Natenstedt Decl., ¶ 8; Cline Decl., ¶ 6, Exh. 1.) The costs appear to be reasonable on their face, and Defendant does not submit any objections to the requested sum. Consequently, the Court

concludes that the requested amount is appropriate.

Accordingly, the Court GRANTS

Plaintiff's motion in the reduced amount of \$53,325.35, calculated as follows:

\$58,392.78 - \$135.00 - \$245.00 - \$4,687.43.

ORDERS

1)

Plaintiff

Imara Jones's Motion for Attorneys' Fees, Costs, and Expenses is GRANTED in the reduced amount of \$53,325.35.

2)

Plaintiff

is ordered to provide notice of this Court's ruling.

IT IS SO ORDERED.

DATED: July 9, 2026

Tamara

Hall

Judge

of the Superior Court